PROJECT BRIEF · PYTHON (GR 6–8) BEGINNER: PYTHON GAME CODERS

Lesson 8: Capstone: Treasure Hunt

Module 2 | 60 minutes | game design, lists, def | Grades 6–10 · ages 11–15

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Your mission
Design and build a text adventure with at least three rooms, an inventory, a locked door, a treasure to win and a torch that runs out.

Checklist

- [ ] A paper map of 3+ rooms, copied into a comment
- [ ] An inventory list that grows with append and is checked with in
- [ ] A while loop game with if / elif for every room and command
- [ ] A win ending and a lose ending (GAME OVER after 10 moves)
- [ ] At least one function you define with def and call
- [ ] quit ends the game and unknown commands do not crash it

Milestones

1. Map, win rule and lose rule designed on paper — done on: _____
2. Game loop, quit and the first room work — done on: _____
3. All rooms, the key and the locked door work — done on: _____
4. Win and lose endings work; a friend has playtested it and you fixed one thing — done on: _____

Plan it

Write the steps of your program in plain English (pseudocode) before you code.

How it will be marked

Criterion	1 · Beginning	2 · Developing	3 · Secure	4 · Excellent

Game design	No clear map or goal	A goal but rooms do not connect clearly	3+ connected rooms, a locked door, win and lose rules	A clever, well-described world with a puzzle that makes the player think
Programming	Crashes or the loop never ends	Loop works but some rooms or items do not	Rooms, inventory, win, lose and quit all work	Also uses functions well, e.g. describe(place), and handles odd input
Lists and functions	No inventory list or function	A list or a function, but not used properly	Inventory with append and in; at least one function called	Several functions that make the code shorter and clearer
Testing and presentation	Not tested	Tested by the maker only	Playtested by someone else and one fix made	Clear instructions, comments, a playtest log and a confident showcase

Want more?

- Add a trap room that ends the game, or a monster that needs an item to pass
- Add a torch refill item that gives 5 extra moves
- Write a describe(place) function and a help command that lists every command

Two stars and a wish

Ask a friend to test your project.

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